UX Research Skills

Cheatsheet for the 18 skills · plan, run, analyze and report user research

18 skills | Python scripts, no installs

Start in 3 steps

1. Install

Once, in Claude Code (or upload the zips in Claude.ai). Replace … with the repository owner.

2. Let it interview you

It asks about your role, product, decision and constraints, and saves a small research-profile.md.

3. Paste real data

Notes, surveys, screenshots, CSV. Pseudonymize participants first (names, e-mails, companies).

```
/plugin marketplace add josepino/ux-research-skills
/plugin install ux-research-skills@ux-research-skills
› Interview me about my research project
```

Workflow

Define
`research-onboarding`
`research-plan`
`method-selector`

›

Prepare
`interview-guide`
`survey-builder`
`participants-recruiting`
`card-sorting-tree-testing`

›

Run & evaluate
`usability-testing`
`heuristic-evaluation`
`transcript-prep`

›

Analyze
`synthesis`
`insight-qa`

›

Communicate
`personas-and-maps`
`research-report`

›

Impact
`research-impact`

Always available: `ethics-bias-review` · `research-ops` · `research-coach`

The 18 skills

ux-research-onboarding — DEFINE

The first time you work with these skills, or when your context changes: it interviews you and writes research-profile.md.

› Interview me about my research project

ux-research-plan — DEFINE

You have a product question and need a study with objectives, questions, hypotheses and a timeline, or you must justify research to a boss.

› Write a research plan to understand why people abandon at payment. I have 3 weeks and a small budget

ux-interview-guide — PREPARE

You need interview questions or a guide, or want your questions reviewed (leading, closed, hypothetical, double-barreled).

› Build a 45-minute interview guide about how people manage their personal finances

ux-participants-recruiting — PREPARE

You must decide who to recruit, how many, how to screen them, what incentive and consent to use, or run accessible research.

› Write a screener and a consent form for 6 interviews with food-delivery app users

ux-usability-testing — RUN & EVALUATE

You want to test a prototype or product with users: tasks, moderator script, metrics and findings.

› Plan a usability test for my prototype with 5 users: tasks, moderator script and metrics

ux-transcript-prep — RUN & EVALUATE

Before analyzing or pasting transcripts into any AI tool: clean them, pseudonymize participants, and review your own moderation.

› Clean these Zoom transcripts and remove participants' personal data before I analyze them

ux-insight-qa — ANALYZE

Before a finding, theme or report reaches stakeholders: is it an insight or just an observation? Do the quotes really exist?

› Check that every quote in my report really appears in the transcripts

ux-research-report — COMMUNICATE

You have findings and need a report, executive summary, presentation or readout message, in your language.

› Write a one-page summary for the director, in Spanish, and render it as HTML

ux-ethics-bias-review — ALWAYS

Before fieldwork and when analyzing: consent, privacy, researcher and survey biases, AI use with participant data, synthetic-user limits.

› Review my plan and interview guide: is it ethical and where could bias creep in?

ux-research-coach — ALWAYS

You are learning, don't know which skill to use, want a concept explained, a quiz, tool advice or guidance on using AI in research.

› I need to improve our checkout and I don't know where to start

ux-method-selector — DEFINE

You doubt between interviews, surveys, usability tests, A/B, card sorting, diary studies, ethnography or another method.

› Interviews or a survey to understand why people don't complete signup?

ux-survey-builder — PREPARE

You will write, review or analyze a survey, or need to score the SUS (or NPS, UMUX-Lite, SEQ).

› Review this satisfaction survey and tell me which questions are leading

ux-card-sorting-tree-testing — PREPARE

You want to organize a menu or information architecture, or validate whether people can find things in a structure.

› I want to reorganize my recipe site's menu. Design the card sort and I'll analyze the results

ux-heuristic-evaluation — RUN & EVALUATE

You want to review a screen, flow or prototype against Nielsen's 10 heuristics before testing with users.

› Run a heuristic evaluation of the checkout flow (screenshots attached)

ux-synthesis — ANALYZE

You have notes, transcripts or open-ended answers and want themes, findings, priorities and recommendations.

› Synthesize these 6 interviews and prioritize the findings (notes labeled P01–P06)

ux-personas-and-maps — COMMUNICATE

You need a persona, empathy map, journey or experience map, or a mental-model analysis.

› Create a persona and a journey map from these interviews

ux-research-impact — IMPACT

After the report: track which decisions your research changed and show its value to the business.

› Build a log of the decisions our research influenced this quarter

ux-research-ops — ALWAYS

You want better notes, debriefs, a research repository, file naming, retros or guardrails for non-researchers doing research.

› Create the folder structure for the checkout study with 6 participants

Scripts you can run yourself

sus_score.py
SUS per participant with grade and consistency flags. Also NPS.
`› sus_score.py responses.csv --lang es`

tree_test_summary.py
Success, directness and 95% confidence interval per task.
`› tree_test_summary.py tree_results.csv`

lint_questions.py
Flags leading, double-barreled, closed, hypothetical and jargon questions (English and Spanish). Heuristic: confirm each alert.
`› lint_questions.py questions.txt --lang es`

problems_matrix.py
Problems × participants with frequency and average severity.
`› problems_matrix.py problems.csv`

analyze_notes.py
Themes with distinct participants and a priority table from tagged notes.
`› analyze_notes.py notes.csv --total-participants 8`

moderator_scorecard.py
Self-review of your moderation: talk share, longest turns, interruptions, leading questions. Not for performance reviews.
`› moderator_scorecard.py session.txt --moderator Moderator`

lint_artifact.py
Checks that a persona, empathy map or journey declares status, evidence and date. --pairs counts comparisons.
`› lint_artifact.py --pairs 15`

cardsort_matrix.py
Similarity matrix between cards and suggested grouping. CSV: participant,group,card.
`› cardsort_matrix.py results.csv --agreement`

sample_size.py
How many participants to recruit for a method, with a no-show buffer.
`› sample_size.py --method usability --segments 2`

lint_tasks.py
Finds clues in usability tasks: product labels, click verbs, “easy/simply”, step-by-step.
`› lint_tasks.py tasks.txt --labels labels.txt`

consolidate_findings.py
Merges the CSVs of several evaluators (file name = evaluator) and flags agreement.
`› consolidate_findings.py ana.csv ben.csv --output summary.md`

verify_quotes.py
Looks for each quote of a report inside the transcripts: verified, approximate or not found.
`› verify_quotes.py --report report.md --transcripts transcripts/`

decision_log.py
Summarizes the decision log: status counts, implementation rate, oldest pending, warnings.
`› decision_log.py log.csv --today 2026-10-01`

validate_profile.py
Checks research-profile.md and warns about e-mails, phones or keys that must not be there.
`› validate_profile.py research-profile.md`

Run with python3 · no installs · --lang es|en

Recipes

New product, validate the idea
1. ux-research-onboarding → ux-research-plan
2. ux-method-selector: discovery interviews + competitors
3. ux-participants-recruiting: screener and consent
4. ux-interview-guide, then ux-transcript-prep
5. ux-synthesis → ux-personas-and-maps

Existing product, conversion is dropping
1. ux-heuristic-evaluation of the flow
2. ux-method-selector: analytics + usability tests
3. ux-usability-testing with 5 users
4. ux-survey-builder: SUS as a baseline
5. ux-synthesis → ux-research-report

Little time, little budget
1. ux-research-plan: ask for the minimum viable version
2. ux-heuristic-evaluation with 3–5 evaluators
3. 5 remote usability sessions
4. ux-research-ops: short debrief after each session

Reorganize menu or navigation
1. ux-card-sorting-tree-testing: open card sort
2. Analyze with cardsort_matrix.py
3. Tree test to validate the new structure
4. ux-research-report: proposed tree

Before going to the field
1. ux-ethics-bias-review on plan, guide and consent
2. lint_questions.py on your questions
3. ux-participants-recruiting: accessibility and data

I have recorded interviews
1. ux-transcript-prep: clean and pseudonymize
2. ux-synthesis: codes, themes with n of N, quotes
3. ux-insight-qa: check insights and quotes
4. ux-research-report → ux-research-impact

Reference numbers

WHAT	REFERENCE	WATCH OUT
Usability tests (qualitative)	5 per round and per segment	3–4 per group if segments overlap
Interviews	5–10 per segment	The “5” from NN/g was meant for usability testing
Quantitative studies	About 40 (NN/g 2021); 30 at 90% confidence	Older sources said 20
Card sorting	15+ per user group	Cards: 30–50 depending on the source
Heuristic evaluation	3–5 independent evaluators	1–2 hours each, narrow scope
SUS	Average 68	Two interpretation scales: cite which one
Survey	Under 10 min, 10–15 questions	Drop-off rises after 7–8 min
Recruiting	Add 20–30 % for no-shows	sample_size.py does it for you

Golden rules

Decision before method. If you don't know what you will decide with the results, there is no study yet.

What people say is not what they do. Combine attitudinal and behavioral data: survey + analytics, interview + usability test.

One question at a time. Open, about concrete moments, no loaded words, no hypotheticals about the future.

Small samples, small claims. With 8 people say “5 of 8”, not “62%”.

Ethics by design. Consent, privacy and bias are reviewed before fieldwork, not after.

AI assists, it doesn't replace. Verify quotes and figures against the source. Don't paste identifiable data without consent.

Reports in your language

`--researcher "Name" --version 1.0`	UX Researcher, version and generation time (date, time, time zone) on the cover and in the print footer
`-o report.pdf`	Branded PDF (Chrome, Chromium or Edge); .html for the web page
`![what is seen](shot.png "why it matters")`	Numbered figure with the description of each screenshot
```` ```chart / ```diagram ````	Bar, line and donut charts; flow, 2x2 and journey diagrams (--guide shows the syntax)
`--lang es|en|…`	Sets the page language and built-in labels (English and Spanish included)
`--labels labels.json`	Any other language: the skill translates the labels and passes them here
`--theme auto|light|dark`	Follows the reader's system theme by default
`> [!insight] / [!recommendation] / [!risk]`	Markdown callouts rendered as colored cards

If something goes wrong